

8.7. Miscellaneous shortcuts

With a comprehensive knowledge on opening and writing of files, you must now be confident enough to attempt different activities with a file. Here are some miscellaneous shortcuts for PHP and the related concepts.

Using these shortcut methods, you can perform different file manipulation activities in PHP. One thing you should necessarily know is that all the shortcut methods require PHP5.

Instead of `fopen()` and `fread()`, you can simply use `file_get_contents` to read and open a file. You only require the file name. By giving a file name, you will receive a series of related contents. See the code below:

```
<?php
$file_contents =
file_get_contents('XYZ.txt');
?>
```

PHP also offers a shortcut for writing on a file. Instead of following the detailed process, you can apply the shortcut method for `fwrite` mentioned below:

```
<?php
file_put_contents('XYZ.txt', 'Hello World!');
```